And he who will act thus will perform good deeds.[20]

Each of these aspects was then amplified in separate edicts, making the pillar edict quoted from above a kind of table of contents listing the various ways in which the cause of dhamma was sought to be furthered.[21]

In order of precedence, the spiritual well-being of people appears at the top. The Third Pillar Edict encourages everyone to take responsibility for their actions, both 'virtuous deeds' and evil actions. Had he heard Shakespeare's Antony argue that 'The evil that men do lives after them/The good is oft interred with their bones', he would have vehemently disagreed: the human tendency, he believes, is to acknowledge good deeds while suppressing the unpalatable—a peculiarly Ashokan notion elicited almost certainly by a recollection of his post-Kalinga contrition where he had publicly accepted his culpability. The harbouring of negative emotions is castigated: 'These (passions), viz. fierceness, cruelty, anger, pride, envy, are called sinful. Let me not ruin (myself) by (these) very (passions).'[22] Vincent Smith, while examining this insistence on self-responsibility, was reminded of a passage in the *Dhammapada*:

By ourselves is evil done,
By ourselves we pain endure,
By ourselves we cease from wrong,
By ourselves become we pure.

No one saves us but ourselves,
No one can and no one may,
We ourselves must tread the Path;
Buddhas only show the way.[23]

In the Separate Rock Edicts of Kalinga too, envy, anger, cruelty, hurry, want of practice, laziness, and fatigue had been specifically warned against, the difference being that in the Kalinga version the warning was intended to keep state officials on their toes.